

How to Run This Project (and open it in Chrome)

No installs needed — the backend only uses Python's standard library, and the database is SQLite (also built into Python). You just need Python 3.10+.

1. Unzip into a fresh folder

Always extract into a **brand-new folder** rather than overwriting an old one. Mixing old and new files is the #1 cause of a broken-looking page.

2. Start the server

Open a terminal (in VS Code: `Ctrl+`` / `Cmd+``), `cd` into the folder that contains `app.py`, and run:

```
bash
python3 app.py
```

(On Windows, use `python app.py` if `python3` isn't recognized.)

You should see:

```
text
Support Coaching Assistant running at http://127.0.0.1:8000
SQLite database: ../database/data/support_coach.db
```

Leave this terminal window open — closing it stops the server.

3. Open it in Chrome

Go to:

```
text
http://127.0.0.1:8000
```

First time only, or after I send you an updated zip: do a hard reload so Chrome doesn't show old cached files instead of the new ones:

Windows/Linux: `Ctrl + Shift + R`

Mac: `Cmd + Shift + R`

If it still looks broken/outdated after that, do a full cache wipe for this page:

Open DevTools (`F12`), right-click the reload button (top-left, next to the address bar) → **Empty Cache and Hard Reload**.

Or go to `chrome://settings/content/all`, search `127.0.0.1`, click it, then **Clear data**.

Or just test in an **Incognito window** (`Ctrl+Shift+N`) first — if it looks correct there, it confirms the problem is Chrome's cache, not the code.

4. Stop the server

Go back to the terminal and press `Ctrl+C`.

Optional: turn on real AI answers

By default the app runs its own built-in rule-based assistant (no internet needed). To have it use a real language model instead for open-ended questions, set an API key before starting it:




```
bash
export OPENAI_API_KEY="your_key_here" # Mac/Linux
$env:OPENAI_API_KEY="your_key_here" # Windows PowerShell
python3 app.py
```

Troubleshooting checklist

Symptom	Fix
Page looks unstyled or half-broken	Hard reload (<code>Ctrl+Shift+R</code>), then try Incognito to confirm it's caching
"This site can't be reached"	The server isn't running — check the terminal, run <code>python3 app.py</code> again
Port already in use	Another instance is still running — close that terminal, or set <code>\$env:APP_PORT="8010"</code> before running
Changes I send don't show up	You're likely running an old extracted folder — unzip fresh, restart the server, hard reload
See <code>README.md</code> for the full project structure, environment variables, and architecture details.	